

# The RSVP Treatise: Semantic Infrastructure and Modular Computation in an Entropy-Respecting Universe

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## Contents

|           |                                                                        |          |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>I</b>  | <b>Foundations</b>                                                     | <b>3</b> |
| <b>1</b>  | <b>Chapter 1: Prelude: Of Attention and Entropy</b>                    | <b>3</b> |
| 1.1       | 1.1 Introduction: The Economy of Cognitive Capture . . . . .           | 3        |
| 1.2       | 1.2 Entropy as the Hidden Currency . . . . .                           | 3        |
| 1.3       | 1.3 RSVP as a Counter-Architecture . . . . .                           | 3        |
| 1.4       | 1.4 From File Systems to Semantic Manifolds . . . . .                  | 4        |
| 1.5       | 1.5 Toward Cognitive Sovereignty . . . . .                             | 4        |
| <b>2</b>  | <b>Chapter 2: RSVP Theory: The Relativistic Scalar-Vector Plenum</b>   | <b>4</b> |
| 2.1       | 2.1 Introduction: From Attention to Semantic Fields . . . . .          | 4        |
| 2.2       | 2.2 The RSVP Framework: Core Definitions . . . . .                     | 4        |
| 2.3       | 2.3 Governing Equations and Variational Principles . . . . .           | 5        |
| 2.4       | 2.4 Category-Theoretic Formalization . . . . .                         | 5        |
| 2.5       | 2.5 RSVP as a Computational Substrate . . . . .                        | 6        |
| 2.6       | 2.6 Conclusion: Toward a Semantic Revolution . . . . .                 | 6        |
| <b>3</b>  | <b>Chapter 3: Semantic Infrastructure as Post-Git Architecture</b>     | <b>6</b> |
| 3.1       | 3.1 Introduction: Beyond Hierarchical File Systems . . . . .           | 6        |
| 3.2       | 3.2 The Limitations of File-Based Systems . . . . .                    | 6        |
| 3.3       | 3.3 Fibered Symmetric Monoidal $\infty$ -Categories . . . . .          | 6        |
| 3.4       | 3.4 Homotopy Colimits for Semantic Merging . . . . .                   | 7        |
| 3.5       | 3.5 Practical Implementation: From Theory to VCS . . . . .             | 7        |
| 3.6       | 3.6 Conclusion: A Modular Substrate . . . . .                          | 7        |
| <b>II</b> | <b>Theoretical Synthesis</b>                                           | <b>7</b> |
| <b>4</b>  | <b>Chapter 4: Simulated Agency: Consciousness as Sparse Projection</b> | <b>7</b> |
| 4.1       | 4.1 Introduction: Agency in an Entropic Universe . . . . .             | 7        |
| 4.2       | 4.2 The Chain of Memory: A Recursive Model . . . . .                   | 7        |
| 4.3       | 4.3 Variational Principles for Simulated Agency . . . . .              | 8        |

|          |                                                                           |           |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 4.4      | 4.4 Category-Theoretic Formalization of Agency . . . . .                  | 8         |
| 4.5      | 4.5 HYDRA and TARTAN: Distributed Agency Architectures . . . . .          | 8         |
| 4.6      | 4.6 Consciousness as Emergent Sparse Projection . . . . .                 | 8         |
| 4.7      | 4.7 Conclusion: Toward Ethical Agency . . . . .                           | 8         |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Chapter 5: Entropic Economics and Cognitive Commons</b>                | <b>8</b>  |
| 5.1      | 5.1 Introduction: Reimagining Economics through Entropy . . . . .         | 8         |
| 5.2      | 5.2 Attention as a Scalar Commodity: A Category-Theoretic Perspective     | 9         |
| 5.3      | 5.3 Sheaf-Theoretic Entropic Economics . . . . .                          | 9         |
| 5.4      | 5.4 Futarchy and Decentralized Governance . . . . .                       | 9         |
| 5.5      | 5.5 HYDRA and TARTAN in Economic Coordination . . . . .                   | 9         |
| 5.6      | 5.6 The Cognitive Commons: Breaking Monopolistic Collapse . . . . .       | 9         |
| 5.7      | 5.7 Conclusion: Toward a Modular Economic Paradigm . . . . .              | 9         |
| <b>6</b> | <b>Chapter 6: Entropic Ethics: Toward Cognitive Sovereignty</b>           | <b>10</b> |
| 6.1      | 6.1 Introduction: The Moral Imperative of Semantic Autonomy . . . . .     | 10        |
| 6.2      | 6.2 The Ethical Pathology of Attention Extraction . . . . .               | 10        |
| 6.3      | 6.3 Category-Theoretic Ethics: Agency as a Functorial Principle . . . . . | 10        |
| 6.4      | 6.4 Sheaf-Theoretic Ethics: Local Coherence, Global Freedom . . . . .     | 10        |
| 6.5      | 6.5 Entropic Ethics in Distributed Architectures . . . . .                | 10        |
| 6.6      | 6.6 Toward Cognitive Sovereignty . . . . .                                | 10        |
| 6.7      | 6.7 Conclusion: A Moral Architecture . . . . .                            | 10        |
| <b>A</b> | <b>Appendix A: RSVP Field Formalism</b>                                   | <b>11</b> |
| A.1      | A.1 Scalar Field ( $\Phi$ ) . . . . .                                     | 11        |
| A.2      | A.2 Vector Field ( $\mathbf{v}$ ) . . . . .                               | 11        |
| A.3      | A.3 Entropy Field ( $S$ ) . . . . .                                       | 11        |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Appendix B: Sparse Projection and Simulated Agency</b>                 | <b>11</b> |
| B.1      | B.1 Chain of Memory . . . . .                                             | 11        |
| B.2      | B.2 Variational Objective . . . . .                                       | 11        |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Appendix C: Category-Theoretic Semantic Infrastructure</b>             | <b>11</b> |
| C.1      | C.1 Semantic Modules . . . . .                                            | 11        |
| C.2      | C.2 Homotopy Colimits . . . . .                                           | 11        |
| C.3      | C.3 Fibered Structure . . . . .                                           | 12        |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Appendix D: HYDRA and TARTAN Formalism</b>                             | <b>12</b> |
| D.1      | D.1 HYDRA Nodes . . . . .                                                 | 12        |
| D.2      | D.2 TARTAN Coordination . . . . .                                         | 12        |
| <b>E</b> | <b>Appendix E: Entropic Economics</b>                                     | <b>12</b> |
| E.1      | E.1 Attention as Commodity . . . . .                                      | 12        |
| E.2      | E.2 Attention–Entropy Tradeoff . . . . .                                  | 12        |
| <b>F</b> | <b>Appendix F: Cosmological Analogy</b>                                   | <b>12</b> |
| F.1      | F.1 Lamphron-Lamphrodyne Dynamics . . . . .                               | 12        |
| <b>G</b> | <b>Appendix G: Implementation Notes</b>                                   | <b>12</b> |

## Part I

# Foundations

## 1 Chapter 1: Prelude: Of Attention and Entropy

### 1.1 1.1 Introduction: The Economy of Cognitive Capture

In the early 21st century, digital platforms transformed from conduits of information to sophisticated engines of attention extraction, driven by imperatives to monetize cognitive bandwidth through advertising, subscriptions, storage, and compute services [?]. This attention economy, as critiqued by ?, operates as an entropy-extraction regime, constraining cognitive trajectories into low-dimensional attractors to maximize behavioral predictability and platform revenue.

The Relativistic Scalar-Vector Plenum (RSVP) framework proposes a counter-architecture, modeling computation and cognition as field-theoretic processes governed by a scalar field ( $\Phi$ ) for semantic coherence, a vector field ( $\mathbf{v}$ ) for directional flows, and an entropy field ( $S$ ) for uncertainty [??]. This paradigm aims to restore cognitive sovereignty, resisting the monopolistic tendencies of Big Tech. Platforms engineer addictive interfaces—feeds, infinite scroll, and notifications—to maximize session duration and lock users into ecosystems [?]. This produces “semantic exhaust” that fuels both data storage monopolies and compute-intensive services like AI indexing. RSVP inverts this dynamic, treating attention not as a commodity but as a flow within an entropy-respecting semantic plenum.

### 1.2 1.2 Entropy as the Hidden Currency

Traditional models treat attention as a finite commodity, but information theory reveals entropy as the deeper invariant [?]. Entropy, measuring system uncertainty, quantifies the cost of prediction in cognitive systems [?]. Platforms reduce semantic entropy by herding users into predictable behavioral regions, collapsing the cognitive state-space into local minima of novelty [?].

Formally, the evolution of entropy in RSVP is governed by:

$$\frac{\partial S}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{v}S) = \kappa \nabla^2 S + \Gamma(\Phi, \mathbf{v}),$$

where  $\kappa$  is the diffusion coefficient of uncertainty and  $\Gamma(\Phi, \mathbf{v})$  represents source or sink terms corresponding to external interventions. The ethical cost of minimizing entropy in this way is the erosion of semantic openness, constraining thought to algorithmically defined attractors [?].

### 1.3 1.3 RSVP as a Counter-Architecture

RSVP reimagines semantic systems as a plenum governed by field dynamics:  $\Phi$  encodes coherence,  $\mathbf{v}$  directs flows, and  $S$  tracks dispersion (see Appendix A). Unlike file-based systems, which fragment meaning into rigid hierarchies [?], RSVP employs a fibered symmetric monoidal  $\infty$ -category  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  [?]. Objects are semantic modules, morphisms are

coherence-preserving transformations, and fibrations model contextual embedding. This categorical structure resists pathological attractors, enabling trajectories that minimize entropy loss while preserving coherence [?].

## 1.4 1.4 From File Systems to Semantic Manifolds

Hierarchical file systems enforce closure, rendering knowledge inert and increasing the cost of integration [?]. RSVP envisions a semantic manifold where version control is a homotopy-theoretic process, allowing multiple branches to coexist without coercive merging [?]. For example, semantic merging is realized as a homotopy colimit (Appendix C.2), preserving information richness while avoiding the lossy constraints of Git-style systems. This restores cognitive sovereignty, ensuring that semantic navigation is not dictated by opaque optimization [?].

## 1.5 1.5 Toward Cognitive Sovereignty

RSVP inverts the externalization of cognition, fostering a computational ecology where agents navigate freely across semantic fields. This chapter establishes the theoretical groundwork: subsequent chapters formalize RSVP through field theory (Chapter 2), semantic infrastructure (Chapter 3), simulated agency (Chapter 4), entropic economics (Chapter 5), and ethics (Chapter 6). Together these developments aim toward a vision of an entropy-respecting computational commons [??].

# 2 Chapter 2: RSVP Theory: The Relativistic Scalar-Vector Plenum

## 2.1 2.1 Introduction: From Attention to Semantic Fields

The attention economy, as delineated in Chapter 1, operates as an entropy-extraction regime, constraining cognitive trajectories to optimize for platform revenue rather than semantic richness [??]. The RSVP framework offers a radically different model, redefining computation and cognition as field-theoretic processes [?]. This chapter formalizes RSVP’s core components—the scalar field  $\Phi$ , vector field  $\mathbf{v}$ , and entropy field  $S$ —and articulates their role in constructing a semantic infrastructure that transcends the limitations of file-based systems [?], drawing parallels to categorical physics [?].

## 2.2 2.2 The RSVP Framework: Core Definitions

RSVP is a triadic field-theoretic model comprising:

- **Scalar Field ( $\Phi$ ):**  $\Phi : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ , encoding semantic coherence over a manifold  $\Omega$ , analogous to a potential in physical systems [?].
- **Vector Field ( $\mathbf{v}$ ):**  $\mathbf{v} \in \Gamma(T\Omega)$ , governing directional semantic flows, akin to velocity fields in fluid dynamics [?].
- **Entropy Field ( $S$ ):**  $S : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$ , quantifying semantic uncertainty [?].

These fields interact via a Lagrangian density:

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}|\nabla\Phi|^2 + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{v} + \lambda S \log S - \mu\Phi \operatorname{div}\mathbf{v},$$

where  $\frac{1}{2}|\nabla\Phi|^2$  ensures coherence stability,  $\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{v}$  penalizes excessive flow,  $\lambda S \log S$  enforces entropic balance, and  $-\mu\Phi \operatorname{div}\mathbf{v}$  couples coherence to flow divergence [?].

## 2.3 2.3 Governing Equations and Variational Principles

The dynamics are governed by an action functional  $\mathcal{S} = \int_{\Omega} \mathcal{L} dV$ , minimized using variational calculus [?]. Varying  $\mathcal{S}$  with respect to  $\Phi$ ,  $\mathbf{v}$ , and  $S$  yields the Euler-Lagrange equations:

$$\Delta\Phi = \mu \operatorname{div}\mathbf{v}, \tag{1}$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{v} = -\nabla\Phi, \tag{2}$$

$$\frac{\partial S}{\partial t} + \operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}S) = \lambda \Delta S. \tag{3}$$

Equation (1) ensures that  $\Phi$  responds to the divergence of semantic flows, Equation (2) describes flow evolution under coherence gradients, and Equation (3) governs entropy transport and diffusion [?]. The term  $\lambda S \log S$  in the Lagrangian derives from information-theoretic principles, ensuring entropy respects probabilistic constraints [?]. These equations form a relativistic system, with a generalized Lorentzian structure on  $\Omega$ , ensuring causal propagation of semantic information [?].

## 2.4 2.4 Category-Theoretic Formalization

To transcend file-based systems, RSVP employs a symmetric monoidal  $\infty$ -category  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  [?], where:

- **Objects:** Semantic modules (e.g., concepts, computational processes).
- **Morphisms:** Entropy-respecting transformations.
- **Fibrations:**  $\pi : \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ , embedding modules in contextual domains (Appendix C.3) [?].

Semantic merging is formalized via a functor:

$$F : \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} \times \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}},$$

computing homotopy colimits  $\operatorname{hocolim}_i X_i$  to integrate branches without loss [?]. For example, merging two documents with divergent edits forms a pushout:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{f} & B \\ \downarrow g & & \downarrow h \\ C & \xrightarrow{k} & D \end{array}$$

This preserves coherence across semantic branches, unlike Git’s linear merges [?].

## 2.5 2.5 RSVP as a Computational Substrate

RSVP redefines computation as navigation within a semantic plenum, replacing discrete instructions with continuous fields [?]. It ensures:

- **Entropy-Respecting Processing:** Aligning with  $\mathbf{v}$  gradients [?].
- **Coherence Preservation:** Maintaining  $\Phi$  integrity

## 2.6 2.6 Conclusion: Toward a Semantic Revolution

RSVP provides a formal counterpoint to attention economies, enabling semantic infrastructures that prioritize cognitive autonomy [?], as explored in Chapter 3.

# 3 Chapter 3: Semantic Infrastructure as Post-Git Architecture

## 3.1 3.1 Introduction: Beyond Hierarchical File Systems

The technical substrate of the attention economy—file systems and version control like Git—fragments semantic coherence, exacerbating entropic extraction [?]. RSVP proposes a semantic infrastructure grounded in  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  [?], enabling modular computation that resists monopolistic coercion

## 3.2 3.2 The Limitations of File-Based Systems

Hierarchical file systems partition meaning into static artifacts, inducing entropic loss by forcing  $\mathbf{v}$  into singular attractors (Appendix A.2) [?]. Git’s directed acyclic graph (DAG) model enforces linear merges, discarding divergent branches and scaling superlinearly with complexity [?]. RSVP counters this with dynamic manifolds, evolving via:

$$\frac{\partial \Phi}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{v}\Phi) = D\nabla^2 \Phi + f(\mathbf{x}, t),$$

ensuring coherence diffusion across  $\Omega$

## 3.3 3.3 Fibered Symmetric Monoidal $\infty$ -Categories

Semantic modules are objects in  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$ , fibered over a base category  $\mathcal{B}$  via  $\pi : \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$  [?]. Cross-domain integration uses pullbacks:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X \times_{\mathcal{B}} Y & \longrightarrow & Y \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \pi_Y \\ X & \xrightarrow{\pi_X} & \mathcal{B} \end{array}$$

For example, integrating a biological ontology with a computational linguistics module preserves coherence across fibers

### 3.4 3.4 Homotopy Colimits for Semantic Merging

Merging employs homotopy colimits (Appendix C.2):

$$\mathrm{hocolim}_i X_i,$$

evolving via:

$$\frac{\partial \Phi_{\text{merge}}}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{v}_{\text{merge}} \Phi_{\text{merge}}) = D \nabla^2 \Phi_{\text{merge}} + \sum_i f_i(\mathbf{x}, t),$$

preserving coherence without destructive entropy collapse

### 3.5 3.5 Practical Implementation: From Theory to VCS

A post-Git version control system (VCS) uses finite difference solvers for PDEs (Appendix G), implemented in Haskell with simplicial sets for homotopy colimits

### 3.6 3.6 Conclusion: A Modular Substrate

RSVP's infrastructure liberates semantic flows, enabling distributed agency (Chapter 4) and entropic economics (Chapter 5)

## Part II

# Theoretical Synthesis

## 4 Chapter 4: Simulated Agency: Consciousness as Sparse Projection

### 4.1 4.1 Introduction: Agency in an Entropic Universe

RSVP models agency as a sparse projection within the plenum, with consciousness emerging from low-dimensional semantic states [??]. This counters the coercive optimization of attention economies, which externalize cognition

### 4.2 4.2 The Chain of Memory: A Recursive Model

The memory state evolves via:

$$M_{t+1} = \Pi(M_t, I_t; \theta),$$

where  $\Pi$  is a sparse projection operator,  $I_t$  is external stimuli, and  $\theta$  encodes learned attractors (Appendix B.1) [?]. This Chain of Memory (CoM) mirrors Bayesian inference, updating beliefs recursively based on sensory inputs

### 4.3 4.3 Variational Principles for Simulated Agency

Agency minimizes a free-energy functional:

$$\mathcal{F}[M_t, \Phi, S] = \mathbb{E}_{M_t}[\ln P(I_t | M_t)] + \beta S(M_t),$$

balancing predictive accuracy and entropic flexibility (Appendix B.2)

### 4.4 4.4 Category-Theoretic Formalization of Agency

Agents are functors  $A : \mathcal{T} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$ , where  $\mathcal{T}$  is a poset of temporal states [?]. The projection  $\Pi$  is a natural transformation:

$$\Pi : A \rightarrow A',$$

ensuring coherence across time

### 4.5 4.5 HYDRA and TARTAN: Distributed Agency Architectures

HYDRA models agents as nodes  $N_i = (\Phi_i, \mathbf{v}_i, S_i)$ , coupled via:

$$\mathbf{v}_i(t+1) = \sum_j A_{ij} \mathbf{v}_j(t) + f_i(t),$$

with stability ensured by eigenvalue analysis of  $A_{ij}$  (Appendix D.1)

### 4.6 4.6 Consciousness as Emergent Sparse Projection

Consciousness emerges as a fixed point:

$$M^* = \arg \min_{M_t} \mathcal{F},$$

robust across domains, aligning with integrated information theory

### 4.7 4.7 Conclusion: Toward Ethical Agency

RSVP enables modular, decentralized agency, setting the stage for entropic economics (Chapter 5)

## 5 Chapter 5: Entropic Economics and Cognitive Commons

### 5.1 5.1 Introduction: Reimagining Economics through Entropy

Entropic economics redefines attention as a dynamic flow within a cognitive commons, contrasting with classical scarcity models



## 5.2 5.2 Attention as a Scalar Commodity: A Category-Theoretic Perspective

Attention  $a_i(t)$  for agents  $i \in \mathcal{A}$  satisfies:

$$\sum_i a_i(t) = A_{\text{total}},$$

with flows governed by:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{v} = -\nabla \Phi + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{v} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}},$$

minimizing external interventions  $\mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}}$  (Appendix E.1)

## 5.3 5.3 Sheaf-Theoretic Entropic Economics

A sheaf  $\mathcal{F} : \mathcal{O}(\Omega)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  assigns local agent states to open sets  $U \subseteq \Omega$ , with gluing:

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \cong \lim \left( \prod_i \mathcal{F}(U_i) \rightrightarrows \prod_{i,j} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j) \right),$$

ensuring local-to-global coherence

## 5.4 5.4 Futarchy and Decentralized Governance

Futarchy maps agents to prediction markets:

$$F_{\text{fut}} : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{P},$$

optimizing:

$$U_i(t) = \Phi_i(t) - \lambda S_i(t),$$

ensuring equitable attention allocation (Appendix E.2)

## 5.5 5.5 HYDRA and TARTAN in Economic Coordination

HYDRA couples nodes via:

$$\mathbf{v}_i(t+1) = \sum_j A_{ij} \mathbf{v}_j(t) + f_i(t),$$

with TARTAN ensuring global coherence (Appendix D)

## 5.6 5.6 The Cognitive Commons: Breaking Monopolistic Collapse

Cohomology  $H^1(\Omega, \mathcal{S})$  quantifies obstructions to global coherence, mitigated by homotopy colimits

## 5.7 5.7 Conclusion: Toward a Modular Economic Paradigm

RSVP enables an entropy-respecting economy, leading to entropic ethics (Chapter 6)

## 6 Chapter 6: Entropic Ethics: Toward Cognitive Sovereignty

### 6.1 6.1 Introduction: The Moral Imperative of Semantic Autonomy

RSVP prioritizes cognitive sovereignty, countering attention extraction

### 6.2 6.2 The Ethical Pathology of Attention Extraction

Coercive systems impose  $\mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}}$ , eroding autonomy via:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{v} = -\nabla \Phi + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{v} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}},$$

increasing  $S$  and reducing diversity (Appendix A.2)

### 6.3 6.3 Category-Theoretic Ethics: Agency as a Functorial Principle

Agents are functors  $A : \mathcal{T} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} [?]$ , with naturality ensuring ethical transitions:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A(t) & \xrightarrow{\Pi} & M_{t+1} \\ \downarrow A(f) & & \downarrow \text{id} \\ A(t') & \xrightarrow{\Pi} & M_{t'+1} \end{array}$$

Violations reflect ethical breaches

### 6.4 6.4 Sheaf-Theoretic Ethics: Local Coherence, Global Freedom

A sheaf  $\mathcal{E} : \mathcal{O}(\Omega)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  ensures coherence

### 6.5 6.5 Entropic Ethics in Distributed Architectures

HYDRA and TARTAN minimize  $\mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}}$  (Appendix D)

### 6.6 6.6 Toward Cognitive Sovereignty

Sovereignty maximizes:

$$U_i(t) = \Phi_i(t) - \lambda S_i(t),$$

supported by global sections

### 6.7 6.7 Conclusion: A Moral Architecture

RSVP fosters a moral architecture, paving the way for Part III

## A Appendix A: RSVP Field Formalism

### A.1 A.1 Scalar Field ( $\Phi$ )

$$\frac{\partial \Phi}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{v}\Phi) = D\nabla^2 \Phi + f(\mathbf{x}, t)?.$$

Derivation: Vary  $\mathcal{S} = \int \mathcal{L} dV$ , yielding coherence-diffusion coupling [?].

### A.2 A.2 Vector Field ( $\mathbf{v}$ )

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{v} = -\nabla \Phi + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{v} + \mathbf{F}_{\text{ext}}?.$$

Derivation: Ensures flow alignment with  $\Phi$ .

### A.3 A.3 Entropy Field ( $S$ )

$$\frac{\partial S}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{v}S) = \kappa \nabla^2 S + \Gamma(\Phi, \mathbf{v})?.$$

Derivation: Balances transport and diffusion

## B Appendix B: Sparse Projection and Simulated Agency

### B.1 B.1 Chain of Memory

$$M_{t+1} = \Pi(M_t, I_t; \theta)?.$$

Derivation: Sparse projection via low-rank factorization

### B.2 B.2 Variational Objective

$$\mathcal{F}[M_t, \Phi, S] = \mathbb{E}_{M_t}[\ln P(I_t | M_t)] + \beta S(M_t)?.$$

Derivation: Balances prediction and entropy

## C Appendix C: Category-Theoretic Semantic Infrastructure

### C.1 C.1 Semantic Modules

Objects and morphisms in  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}$  ?.

### C.2 C.2 Homotopy Colimits

$$\text{hocolim}_i X_i?.$$

Example: Merging documents forms a pushout

### C.3 C.3 Fibered Structure

$$\pi : \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}?$$

## D Appendix D: HYDRA and TARTAN Formalism

### D.1 D.1 HYDRA Nodes

$$\mathbf{v}_i(t+1) = \sum_j A_{ij} \mathbf{v}_j(t) + f_i(t)?.$$

Stability: Eigenvalues of  $A_{ij}$  ensure convergence.

### D.2 D.2 TARTAN Coordination

$$T : \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}^{\text{local}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\text{RSVP}}^{\text{global}}?.$$

## E Appendix E: Entropic Economics

### E.1 E.1 Attention as Commodity

$$\sum_i a_i(t) = A_{\text{total}}?.$$

### E.2 E.2 Attention–Entropy Tradeoff

$$U_i(t) = \Phi_i(t) - \lambda S_i(t)?.$$

## F Appendix F: Cosmological Analogy

### F.1 F.1 Lamphron-Lamphrodyne Dynamics

$$\frac{d\rho}{dt} = -\nabla \cdot (\rho \mathbf{v}) + \eta \nabla^2 \rho?.$$

## G Appendix G: Implementation Notes

Finite difference solvers for PDEs, tensor factorization for  $\Pi$ , simplicial sets in Haskell, and blockchain/Docker deployment